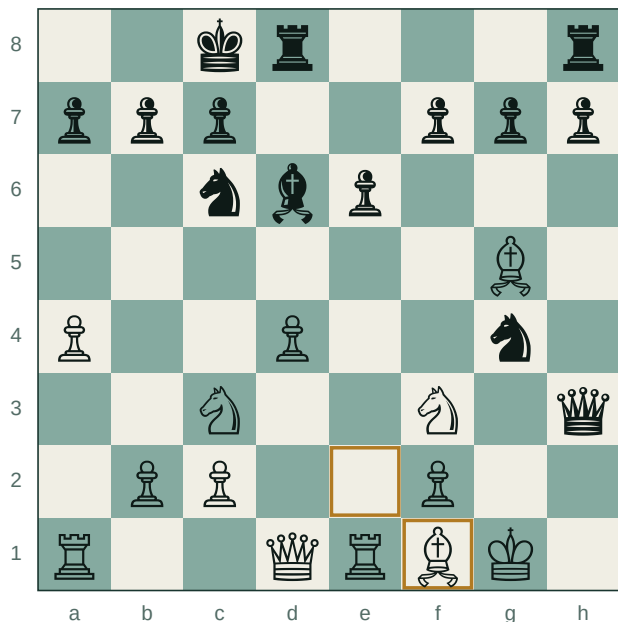


Deflection tactics: Black, move 14

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 14.Bf1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

14...Bh2+ 15. Kh1 Nxf2#

14...Bh2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **15.Kh1**.

15...Nxf2# Mate: knight on f2 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Knight on f2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.